

NEANDERTHAL

Written by

Burt Burlington

Address
Phone Number

INT. HIGH SCHOOL HALLWAY - NOON

Many students inhabit the hallways. Students with their backpacks walk up and down the hallway or are standing in small groups.

The SCHOOLBELL RINGS.

The eyes from some students turn white when they see something WALK down the hallway. More students notice the distraction that pulls the gaze from others.

Some students mouths drop when they look at what is coming closer.

Brown eyes shift from left to right, looking in fear.

STUDENT 1 (15) points at the direction everyone is looking at with utter disbelief. We hear people GIGGLE in the back.

STUDENT 1
It looks like Neanderthal!

We see OTTO (13, giant bulging embossed with wrinkles, zits, chubby, unibrow, big wide nose, short) walk through the crowd with his backpack strapped over his shoulders. Otto looks up and to the side to see the disapproving or laughing faces from his fellow students.

Otto starts the WALK faster, becoming teary-eyed.

STUDENT 2 (O.C.)
(female voice, laughing)
Suzy, look out it's a gorilla!

STUDENT 3
Oh I'm sorry Mitch, couldn't see
you behind Otto's forehead!

The hallways are filled with an abundance of LAUGHTER by all the STUDENTS.

Otto starts to RUN away from the HOWLING LAUGHTER.
His face is beet red when he turns the corner.

There he gets into a COLLISION with EMMA (16, blond, tall, beautiful) and they both fall back ass on the floor.

EMMA
Auw!

Otto feels his forehead and Emma goes back to sitting upright. Students start to surround the the two.

Otto looks at Emma.

OTTO
I-I... I'm sorry.

Emma looks at him in utter disgust.

EMMA
(quietly)
Iew...

Otto's eyes turn white and freeze inside his skull, staring into the void.

STUDENT 1
You would think that blow would fix
his forehead.

Says Student 1 while looking down at Otto with the rest of the students who are LAUGHING.

Otto stands up and RUSHES AWAY, hiding his tears under his hands and forehead.

INT. OTTO HOME KITCHEN - NOON

FATHER (40, average looking, clean, shirt, khaki's) is preparing dinner at the dinner table.

The BACKDOOR FLIES OPEN and Otto darts through the room, tears running down his cheeks.

Father looks up worried, struggles to locate Otto who runs out of the room.

FATHER
Otto, what's matter?
Otto!

Father stands up and goes after Otto.

OTTO (O.S.)
I don't want to go to school
anymore!

We hear Otto WALK UP the STAIRS.

We hear Otto's bedroom door be THROWN SHUT.

INT. OTTO'S BEDROOM

Otto is sitting at his desk in front of his computer, hiding his face under his arms, CRYING.

Father KNOCKS at the door and tries to OPEN it but it's LOCKED.

FATHER (O.S.)
Otto, please tell me what is wrong.
Why don't you want to go to school
tomorrow?

Otto buries his face deeper between his arms.

FATHER (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Otto?

OTTO
(crying, muffled)
Everybody bullies me!

Otto yells in his own sleeves.

FATHER (O.S.)
But why would they bully you?

Otto tilts his head up from his arms, keeps their eyes dripping with tears shut.

OTTO
They call me a Neanderthal.

Otto drops his head back.

CUT TO:

INT. UPSTAIRS HALLWAY

Father is standing in front of Otto's bedroom door which is right next to the stairs.

Father tilts his head back and closes his eyes.
He SIGHS.

CUT TO:

INT. OTTO'S BEDROOM

Otto is quietly CRYING at his desk.

Carefully he looks up and looks at the door.

OTTO
Are you still there, dad?

Otto looks in angst while the door doesn't talk back.

CUT TO:

INT. UPSTAIRS HALLWAY

Father is sitting on the ground with his back against the bedroom door.

FATHER
I am. I am sorry buddy, but you
have to go to school if you like it
or not.

OTTO (O.S.)
But isn't there something we can
do?

FATHER
(confused)
What would you propose?

OTTO (O.S.)
Can't we 'fix' my forehead?

FATHER
What? What do you mean?

CUT TO:

INT. OTTO'S BEDROOM

Otto looks at himself in the reflection of the monitor.
His giant forehead clearly visible.

FATHER (O.S.)
I don't think it is wise to-.

OTTO
-.Like an operation?

CUT TO:

INT. UPSTAIRS HALLWAY

Father jumps up from the floor.

FATHER

What? No!
Out of the question.

OTTO (O.S.)

But dad I-.

FATHER

I said no and that's that.

Father starts WALKING DOWN the STAIRS.

CUT TO:

INT. OTTO'S BEDROOM

Otto looks at himself in the reflection, with tremendous sadness on his face.

FATHER (O.S.)

And you are going to school
tomorrow!

Otto BURSTS into tears, again, hiding away from the world in his arms.

FADE OUT.

FADE IN:

INT. OTTO HOME KITCHEN - EVENING

It's dark out and the family are setting the table.

Father is wearing an apron and oven gloves while he puts the a platter of steaming hot potatoes on table. MOTHER (40, pants suit) is dividing the cutleries.

Otto's SISTER (7, pink dress) walks in and sits down.

MOTHER

Honey, have called Otto?

FATHER

A few times already but he doesn't
respond, and his door is locked

Mother puts a knife down and looks at Father.

MOTHER

But why, what's the matter?

Father doesn't look at her.

FATHER
I don't know, he hasn't spoken a
word to me since he came home from
school this afternoon-.

(BANG)

A dull bang comes from up stairs.

Father and Mother look at each other, their bottom lips
dropping an inch.

Again the LOUD POUND ravel through the ceiling.

Otto's Sister looks up afraid, having her index finger in her
mouth.

FATHER (CONT'D)
Otto is that you!

The only response is another DULL BANG.

Father throws off his oven gloves and runs out of the room
with Mother and Sister walking behind him.

The THUMPING is starting to become more regular.

INT. UPSTAIRS HALLWAY

The family RUNS UP the STAIRS in harmony with LOUDER BANGS.

The THUMPING have started to become QUICKER, more AGGRESSIVE
and SOGGY.

Father tries to open the door but it's still locked

FATHER
(disturbed)
Otto open this door immediately!

Father is hopelessly RATTLING the DOOR HANDLE.
The frequency of the BANGING is decreasing.

MOTHER
(panic)
Kick open the door Frank!

Without questioning Father tries KICKING open the DOOR.

MOTHER (CONT'D)
Quickly Frank.

Sister is starting CRY.

At that moment, the thumping stopped completely.

Father looks down at his wife and his daughter is worryingly.

We hear the LOUDEST and DULLEST BANG of all.

INT. OTTO'S BEDROOM

Father succeeds in KICKING OPEN the DOOR, splintering the wood at the lock.

The family steps inside Otto's room.

On the floor is Otto lying on his back. His forehead smashed into his own skull. Blood is pouring through the gaps and visible pieces of skull. The solid wooden wall in front of him is covered in bumps, bumps, pieces of bone and flesh.

With his face drizzled with blood, he looks at the ceiling smiling.

Otto slowly starts to turn his head towards his horrified family. The turning reveals holes to look inside his head.

OTTO
(quietly)
It's alright.
I'm normal now...

FADE TO BLACK.

THE END